

F5 Daily Briefing – Monday, May 18, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

15

ANNOUNCEMENTS

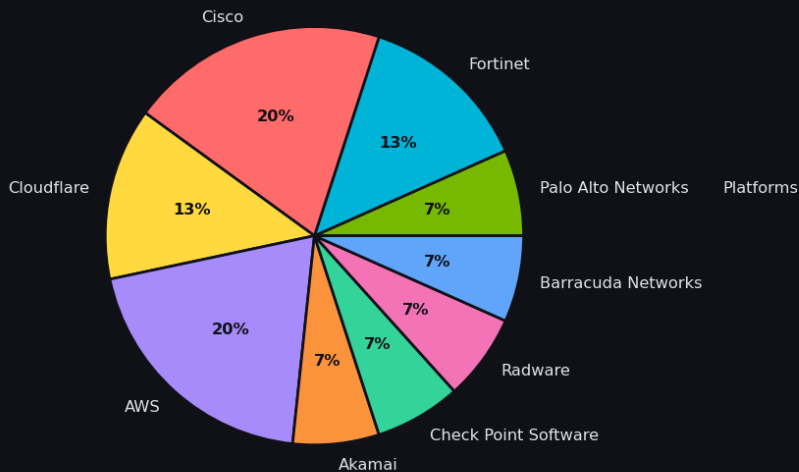
9

ACTIVE

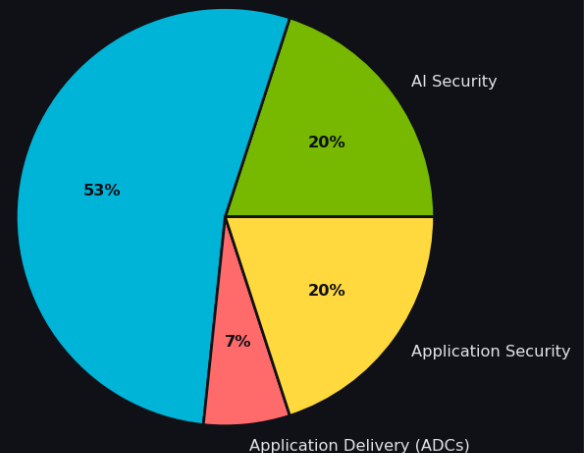
4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (15)

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-05-18

AWS Announces CDK Mixins for Composable Resource Abstractions

AWS released CDK Mixins, a new Cloud Development Kit feature enabling composable, reusable abstractions that can be applied to any construct (L1, L2, or custom) after creation. The capability decouples abstractions from implementations, supports cross-service composition with type safety, and provides day-one access to new AWS features without rewriting existing constructs. CDK Mixins complement Aspects and ship with aws-cdk-lib.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/devops/announcing-aws-cdk-mixins-composable-abstractions-for-aws-resources/>

PRODUCT UPDATE

AWS

2026-05-18

AWS SAM CLI Adds CloudFormation Language Extensions Support

AWS announced enhancements to the AWS SAM CLI that add native CloudFormation Language Extensions support to accelerate local serverless development. The update enables richer CloudFormation language features directly in the SAM workflow, streamlining authoring and testing of serverless applications locally before deployment to production.

Source: <https://aws-news.com/article/2026-05-18-aws-sam-cli-adds-aws-cloudformation-language-extensions-support-to-accelerate-local-serverless-development>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-05-18

AWS Weekly Roundup: AWS Transform Hits 1 Year, Claude Platform on AWS, AWS Security Agent

AWS marked the one-year milestone of AWS Transform, its agentic AI modernization service, which has migrated hundreds of thousands of servers, saved 1.6M engineering hours, and processed 4.5B+ lines of code across .NET, mainframe, and VMware workloads. The roundup also highlighted Claude Platform on AWS, EC2 M3 Ultra Mac instances, Redshift RG instances on Graviton, Bedrock Advanced Prompt Optimization, and the new AWS Security Agent providing context-aware code scanning across full repositories.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-weekly-roundup-aws-transform-at-1-year-claude-platform-on-aws-ec2-m3-ultra-mac-instances-and-more-may-18-2026/>

FINANCIAL**Akamai**

2026-05-18

Akamai Proposes \$2.6B Convertible Notes Offering to Fund Cloud Computing Expansion

Akamai Technologies announced plans to raise \$2.6B through two tranches of 0% convertible senior notes due 2030 and 2032 (\$1.3B each), sold to qualified institutional buyers under Rule 144A. Proceeds will fund expansion of Akamai's global cloud computing footprint and general corporate purposes. Akamai also amended its credit agreement to raise its maximum consolidated leverage ratio to 4.75:1.00 for the next two fiscal quarters, signaling aggressive cloud infrastructure investment.

Source: <https://www.theglobeandmail.com/investing/markets/stocks/AKAM-Q/pressreleases/2001456/akamai-announces-proposed-offering-of-convertible-senior-notes/>

PARTNERSHIP**Barracuda Networks**

2026-05-18

Barracuda and CyberCert Partner to Streamline SMB1001 Compliance for SMEs via MSPs

Barracuda Networks announced a partnership with CyberCert and MSPs to simplify SMB1001 cybersecurity compliance for small and medium enterprises across Australia and New Zealand. BarracudaONE will deliver SMB1001-aligned product packages including email security, data protection, network and remote access protection, and Managed XDR via MSP-led delivery. Sponsored CyberCert Certification Credits lower entry costs while integrating compliance into existing managed services to help SMEs demonstrate baseline controls against AI-driven threats.

Source: <https://channellife.co.nz/story/barracuda-cybercert-ease-smb1001-compliance-for-smes>

RESEARCH REPORT**Check Point Software**

2026-05-18

Check Point Research Publishes May 18 Threat Intelligence Report

Check Point Research released its mid-May 2026 Threat Intelligence Report covering the latest cyber threat landscape, notable campaigns, threat actors, malware trends, and defensive recommendations. The report surfaces evolving attacker techniques, prioritized target sectors, indicators of compromise, and strategic guidance for organizations to strengthen detection and response capabilities.

Source: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/18th-may-threat-intelligence-report/>

CORPORATE RESTRUCTURING**Cisco**

2026-05-18

Cisco Announces 4,000 Job Cuts to Refocus on AI Infrastructure, Silicon, and Security

Cisco disclosed a workforce reduction of nearly 4,000 employees as part of a broad restructuring to reallocate resources toward AI infrastructure, custom silicon, optics, and security. The move pairs with Q3 FY26 revenue of \$15.84B (+12% YoY), full-year guidance of \$62.8-\$63.0B, and participation in a high-speed optical connectivity initiative with Meta and Arista. Pre-tax restructuring charges may reach \$1B across FY26 Q4 and FY27.

Source: <https://finance.yahoo.com/markets/stocks/articles/cisco-job-cuts-reshape-ai-121226522.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-05-18

Cisco Announces Foundry Security Spec for Agentic AI Security Evaluation

Cisco unveiled the Foundry Security Spec, an open-sourced blueprint for building agentic security evaluation systems that are model- and stack-agnostic. The framework helps defenders move from noisy alerts to verifiable security findings by pairing automated harnesses with skilled professionals, scaling vulnerability discovery and remediation against frontier AI risks. Foundry integrates with CodeGuard and is available via Cisco DevNet and GitHub for community contributions.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/announcing-foundry-security-spec>

EXECUTIVE COMMENTARY**Cisco**

2026-05-18

Cisco CEO Frames AI as Networking 'Super Cycle' and Raises Infrastructure Target to \$9B

At the JPMorgan Technology Conference, Cisco CEO Chuck Robbins described AI as fueling a networking super cycle with broad demand across hyperscalers, enterprises, sovereign clouds, and public sector. Cisco raised its FY26 AI infrastructure target to \$9B from \$5B, highlighting five hyperscaler design wins, growth in line-rate security on Smart Switches, and strategic value from its Silicon One and Acacia/Luxtera optics assets driving an accelerated refresh cycle.

Source: <https://www.marketbeat.com/instant-alerts/cisco-systems-ceo-sees-ai-fueling-a-networking-super-cycle-2026-05-18/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Cloudflare**

2026-05-18

Cloudflare Adds Local Dev Server Sharing via Cloudflare Tunnel in Wrangler and Vite

Cloudflare released a new developer feature letting engineers share local dev servers through Cloudflare Tunnel directly from Wrangler and the Vite plugin. Developers can publish a public URL using either a quick *.trycloudflare.com tunnel or a named tunnel with stable hostname and Cloudflare Access controls. The capability supports preview sharing, webhook testing, and cross-device app access with a single keystroke during a running dev session.

Source: <https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-05-18-local-dev-tunnels/>

RESEARCH REPORT**Cloudflare**

2026-05-18

Cloudflare Tests Mythos Bug-Bounty Framework Across 50+ Repositories, Chains Exploits

Cloudflare detailed results from testing its Mythos vulnerability discovery harness across more than 50 open-source repositories. The framework demonstrated the ability to chain multiple individually low-severity bugs into single working exploits, highlighting how AI-assisted offensive security tooling can streamline vulnerability disclosure. Cloudflare's Grant Bourzikas published findings showing implications for security tooling and the future of automated AI-driven bug discovery.

Source: <https://www.techmeme.com/260518/p38>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Fortinet**

2026-05-18

Fortinet Expands FortiCNAPP with Unified Cloud Risk Management

Fortinet announced major enhancements to FortiCNAPP, unifying cloud posture, DSPM, vulnerabilities, runtime behavior, and network enforcement into a single workflow. New capabilities include built-in data sensitivity scanning, business-impact-driven prioritization, and runtime-informed risk evaluation. The update aims to reduce alert noise and tool sprawl while helping security teams prioritize real-world cloud exposure based on correlated context.

Source: <https://blog.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-expands-forticnapp-cloud-risk-management-with-network-data-and-unified-risk-context>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Fortinet**

2026-05-18

Fortinet Introduces FortiOS 8.0 with Secure AI Controls and Fabric-Based AI Agents

At Accelerate 2026, Fortinet unveiled FortiOS 8.0, the latest Security Fabric operating system featuring AI-driven secure networking controls, fabric-based AI agents, flexible SASE, simplified SD-WAN, and quantum-safe security. The release expands Fortinet's unified platform to support digital transformation and AI adoption while reducing complexity and operational overhead across networking and security domains.

Source: <https://www.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-introduces-fortios-8-expand-secure-networking-with-secure-ai-controls-fabric-based-ai-agents-flexible-sase-and-simplified-sdwan>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-18

Palo Alto Networks Launches Idira Identity Security Platform for AI Era

Palo Alto Networks announced Idira, a next-generation identity security platform built on its CyberArk acquisition. Idira replaces persistent privileged access with dynamic, zero-standing-privilege provisioning across a unified control plane, governing human, machine, and agentic AI identities. The platform integrates with Strata, Cortex, Prisma Browser, and Prisma AIRS 3.0 to surface hidden entitlements, recommend least privilege, and automate remediation against identity-related breaches that hit 90% of organizations last year.

Source: <https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/palo-alto-networks-rebrands-cyberark-with-idira-platform-release/>

FINANCIAL**Radware**

2026-05-18

Radware Announces New \$80 Million Share Repurchase Plan

Radware's board authorized a new \$80M share repurchase plan, the '2026 Plan,' valid through March 15, 2027. The buyback authorization allows management to purchase ordinary shares via open market, private negotiations, and other lawful methods subject to Rule 10b-18 and 10b5-1 conditions. The program reinforces Radware's capital return strategy as it continues to grow cloud security, API protection, and DefensePro X DDoS offerings.

Source: <https://www.radware.com/newsevents/pressreleases/2026/radware-announces-new-80-million-share-repurchase-plan/>